

MARKDOWN

CHEAT SHEETS

A Complete Reference for Modern Markdown

Headings

Emphasis

Lists

Links & Images

Tables

Blockquotes

Code Blocks

Language IDs

Inline & Display Math

Greek Letters

Operators & Symbols

LaTeX Structures

Arrows

Math Fonts

Delimiters

GFM Extras

Obsidian

MathJax / KaTeX

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Covers [CommonMark](#) · [GFM](#) · [Obsidian](#) · [MathJax / KaTeX](#) (2025)

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Sheet 1

Markdown Syntax

Headings · Emphasis · Lists · Links · Images · Tables · Blockquotes · GFM extras

Sheet 2

Code Blocks & Math

Inline code · Fenced blocks · Language IDs · Inline & display LaTeX · Renderer support

Sheet 3

LaTeX Reference

Greek letters · Operators & symbols · Structures · Arrows · Math fonts · Delimiters

MARKDOWN SOURCE SYNTAX

```
# Heading 1
## Heading 2
### Heading 3
#### Heading 4
##### Heading 5
##### Heading 6
```

```
Alt Heading 1 (Setext)
=====
Alt Heading 2 (Setext)
-----
```

```
**bold**      *italic*      ***bold italic***
__bold__     _italic_      ___bold italic___
~~strikethrough~~
==highlight==
`inline code`
```

- Unordered item * Also valid + Also valid
 - Nested item (2 spaces indent)
 - Double nested

1. Ordered item
2. Second item
 1. Nested ordered

- [x] Checked task (GFM / Obsidian)
- [] Unchecked task

```
[Link text](https://example.com)
[Link with title](https://example.com "Hover title")
[Reference link][ref-id]
[ref-id]: https://example.com "Optional title"
https://autolink.com            <auto@link.email>    (GFM)
```

```
![Alt text](image.jpg)
![Alt text](image.jpg "Optional title")
[![Image link](img.jpg)](https://example.com)
```

Column 1	Column 2	Column 3
left	centered	right
default	aligned	aligned

```
> Blockquote line
> > Nested blockquote (two > symbols)
>> Nested blockquote (also valid)
```

```
---                    Horizontal rule (also: *** or ___)
```

Indented code block (4 spaces or 1 tab)

```
```python
fenced_code_block = "language hint after backticks"
```

\escape\* special \characters\` with backslash

&amp;    &lt;    &gt;    HTML entities work too

<!-- HTML comment -- hidden in rendered output -->
```

HEADINGS

| SYNTAX | RENDERS AS |
|--------|------------|
|--------|------------|

| | |
|----------|-----------|
| # H1 | Heading 1 |
| ## H2 | Heading 2 |
| ### H3 | Heading 3 |
| #### H4 | Heading 4 |
| ##### H5 | Heading 5 |
| ##### H6 | Heading 6 |

EMPHASIS & INLINE

| SYNTAX | RENDERS AS | SUPPORT |
|--------|------------|---------|
|--------|------------|---------|

| | | |
|----------------------|---------------------------|----------------|
| **text** or __text__ | bold | All |
| *text* or _text_ | <i>italic</i> | All |
| ***text*** | <i>bold italic</i> | All |
| ~~text~~ | strikethrough | GFM / Obsidian |
| ==text== | highlight | Obsidian |
| `code` | inline | All |

LINKS & IMAGES

| SYNTAX | NOTES |
|--------|-------|
|--------|-------|

| | |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| [text](url) | Inline link |
| [text](url "title") | Link with tooltip |
| [text][id] ... [id]: url | Reference-style link |
| <url> | Auto-link (GFM bare URLs also work) |
| ![alt](url) | Image |
| ![[file.png]] | Obsidian internal embed |
| [[Page Name]] | Obsidian wikilink |

TABLES (GFM)

| ALIGNMENT SYNTAX | EFFECT |
|------------------|--------|
|------------------|--------|

| | |
|-------|------------------------|
| --- | Left-aligned (default) |
| :---: | Centered |
| ---: | Right-aligned |

FLAVOR NOTES

- › **CommonMark** — strict spec; base for most renderers
- › **GFM** (GitHub Flavored) — adds tables, task lists, ~~strikethrough~~, autolinks, fenced code
- › **Obsidian** — GFM + ==highlight==, ![[embeds]], [[wikilinks]], ^**block-refs**, callouts
- › Blank line between paragraphs is *required* — single newlines are joined
- › Two trailing spaces or \ at line end forces a line break
- › Indent nested lists with **2–4 spaces** consistently
- › Escape special characters with \ — works on: * _ ` [] () # + - . ! |

OBSIDIAN CALLOUTS

```
> [!note]
> [!tip]            [!important]    [!warning]
> [!caution]      [!info]          [!example]
> [!quote]        [!abstract]      [!success]
> [!failure]      [!bug]            [!question]

> [!tip]+ Collapsible (open by default)
> [!tip]- Collapsible (closed by default)
```

CODE BLOCK SYNTAX

```
`single backtick`           ← inline code

``contains a `backtick` inside``  ← double backticks when content has one

```
plain fenced block – no highlighting
```

```python
fenced block with language hint
print("syntax highlighted")
```

~~~python
tildes also work as fence delimiters
~~~

    indented block (4 spaces / 1 tab)
    – no language hint, no line numbers
    – avoid mixing with fenced style
```

COMMON LANGUAGE IDENTIFIERS

| HINT | LANGUAGE | HINT | LANGUAGE |
|---------|--------------|------------|--------------|
| python | Python | js | JavaScript |
| ts | TypeScript | jsx | React JSX |
| html | HTML | css | CSS |
| java | Java | cpp | C++ |
| c | C | cs | C# |
| rust | Rust | go | Go |
| php | PHP | rb | Ruby |
| swift | Swift | kt | Kotlin |
| sql | SQL | bash | Bash / Shell |
| sh | Shell | zsh | Zsh |
| json | JSON | yaml | YAML |
| toml | TOML | xml | XML |
| md | Markdown | latex | LaTeX |
| r | R | matlab | MATLAB |
| diff | Diff / patch | dockerfile | Dockerfile |
| graphql | GraphQL | regex | Regex |

MATH / LATEX SYNTAX

```
<!-- — Inline math ————— -->
$E = mc^2$                               ← inline (single dollar)
\ (E = mc^2 \)                            ← inline (LaTeX delimiter)

<!-- — Display / block math ————— -->
$$
E = mc^2
$$

\[
\int_0^\infty e^{-x^2} dx = \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2}
\]

<!-- — Obsidian: also supports inline blocks — -->
$$E = mc^2$$                             ← single-line display block

<!-- — Aligned equations (amsmath) ————— -->
$$
\begin{align}
a &= b + c \\
x &= y - z
\end{align}
$$

<!-- — Matrix ————— -->
$$
\begin{pmatrix}
a & b \\
c & d
\end{pmatrix}
$$

<!-- — Cases ————— -->
$$
f(x) = \begin{cases}
x^2 & \text{if } x \geq 0 \\
-x & \text{if } x < 0
\end{cases}
$$
```

RENDERER SUPPORT

| FEATURE | GITHUB | OBSIDIAN | PANDOC | VS CODE |
|----------------------------|--------|----------|--------|---------|
| <code>\$inline\$</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>\$\$block\$\$</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>\ (\) inline</code> | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>\[\] block</code> | ✗ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>align env</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>matrix env</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>cases env</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |
| <code>\text{}</code> | ✓ | ✓ | ✓ | ext |

✓ native

ext requires extension

✗ not supported

GitHub uses **MathJax**; Obsidian uses **MathJax** (configurable); Pandoc can output to MathJax, KaTeX, or native PDF via LaTeX

VS Code: install *Markdown+Math* or *Markdown Preview Enhanced*

| GREEK LETTERS | | | |
|-----------------------|------------|--------------------------|------------|
| COMMAND | OUTPUT | COMMAND | OUTPUT |
| <code>\alpha</code> | α | <code>\Alpha</code> | A |
| <code>\beta</code> | β | <code>\Beta</code> | B |
| <code>\gamma</code> | γ | <code>\Gamma</code> | Γ |
| <code>\delta</code> | δ | <code>\Delta</code> | Δ |
| <code>\epsilon</code> | ϵ | <code>\varepsilon</code> | ϵ |
| <code>\zeta</code> | ζ | <code>\eta</code> | η |
| <code>\theta</code> | θ | <code>\Theta</code> | Θ |
| <code>\iota</code> | ι | <code>\kappa</code> | κ |
| <code>\lambda</code> | λ | <code>\Lambda</code> | Λ |
| <code>\mu</code> | μ | <code>\nu</code> | ν |
| <code>\xi</code> | ξ | <code>\Xi</code> | Ξ |
| <code>\pi</code> | π | <code>\Pi</code> | Π |
| <code>\rho</code> | ρ | <code>\varrho</code> | ϱ |
| <code>\sigma</code> | σ | <code>\Sigma</code> | Σ |
| <code>\tau</code> | τ | <code>\upsilon</code> | υ |
| <code>\phi</code> | ϕ | <code>\Phi</code> | Φ |
| <code>\chi</code> | χ | <code>\psi</code> | ψ |
| <code>\omega</code> | ω | <code>\Omega</code> | Ω |

| OPERATORS & SYMBOLS | | | |
|-------------------------|--------------|------------------------|-------------|
| COMMAND | OUTPUT | COMMAND | OUTPUT |
| <code>\times</code> | $\times$ | <code>\div</code> | $\div$ |
| <code>\pm</code> | $\pm$ | <code>\mp</code> | $\mp$ |
| <code>\cdot</code> | $\cdot$ | <code>\circ</code> | $\circ$ |
| <code>\leq</code> | $\leq$ | <code>\geq</code> | $\geq$ |
| <code>\neq</code> | $\neq$ | <code>\approx</code> | $\approx$ |
| <code>\equiv</code> | $\equiv$ | <code>\sim</code> | $\sim$ |
| <code>\ll</code> | $\ll$ | <code>\gg</code> | $\gg$ |
| <code>\subset</code> | $\subset$ | <code>\supset</code> | $\supset$ |
| <code>\subseteq</code> | $\subseteq$ | <code>\supseteq</code> | $\supseteq$ |
| <code>\in</code> | $\in$ | <code>\notin</code> | $\notin$ |
| <code>\cup</code> | $\cup$ | <code>\cap</code> | $\cap$ |
| <code>\land</code> | $\wedge$ | <code>\lor</code> | $\vee$ |
| <code>\not</code> | $\neg$ | <code>\forall</code> | $\forall$ |
| <code>\exists</code> | $\exists$ | <code>\nexists</code> | $\nexists$ |
| <code>\infty</code> | ∞ | <code>\partial</code> | ∂ |
| <code>\nabla</code> | ∇ | <code>\emptyset</code> | $\emptyset$ |
| <code>\therefore</code> | $\therefore$ | <code>\because</code> | $\because$ |
| <code>\perp</code> | $\perp$ | <code>\parallel</code> | $\parallel$ |

| STRUCTURES | |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| COMMAND | RENDERS AS |
| <code>\frac{a}{b}</code> | a / b (fraction) |
| <code>\tfrac{a}{b}</code> | a/b (inline-sized) |
| <code>\dfrac{a}{b}</code> | a / b (display-sized) |
| <code>\sqrt{x}</code> | $\sqrt{x}$ |
| <code>\sqrt[n]{x}</code> | $\sqrt[n]{x}$ |
| <code>x^{n}</code> | x^n (superscript) |
| <code>x_{n}</code> | x_n (subscript) |
| <code>\sum_{i=0}^n</code> | Σ from $i=0$ to n |
| <code>\prod_{i=1}^n</code> | Π from $i=1$ to n |
| <code>\int_a^b</code> | $\int$ from a to b |
| <code>\iint</code> | $\iint$ double integral |
| <code>\oint</code> | $\oint$ contour integral |
| <code>\lim_{x \rightarrow 0}</code> | $\lim$ as $x \rightarrow 0$ |
| <code>\binom{n}{k}</code> | $\binom{n}{k}$ (n choose k) |
| <code>\overline{AB}</code> | $\overline{AB}$ (overline) |
| <code>\hat{x}</code> | $\hat{x}$ (hat accent) |
| <code>\vec{v}</code> | $\vec{v}$ (vector arrow) |
| <code>\dot{x}</code> | $\dot{x}$ (dot accent) |

| ARROWS | | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------|-------------------|
| COMMAND | OUTPUT | COMMAND | OUTPUT |
| <code>\to</code> | $\rightarrow$ | <code>\gets</code> | $\leftarrow$ |
| <code>\rightarrow</code> | $\rightarrow$ | <code>\leftarrow</code> | $\leftarrow$ |
| <code>\Rrightarrow</code> | $\Rightarrow$ | <code>\Lleftarrow</code> | $\Leftarrow$ |
| <code>\leftrightharrow</code> | $\leftrightarrow$ | <code>\Leftrightarrow</code> | $\Leftrightarrow$ |
| <code>\uparrow</code> | $\uparrow$ | <code>\downarrow</code> | $\downarrow$ |
| <code>\mapsto</code> | $\mapsto$ | <code>\hookrightarrow</code> | $\hookrightarrow$ |
| <code>\iff</code> | $\Leftrightarrow$ | <code>\implies</code> | $\Rightarrow$ |

| MATH FONT & STYLE | | |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|
| COMMAND | EFFECT | EXAMPLE |
| <code>\mathbf{x}</code> | Bold upright | $\mathbf{x}$ |
| <code>\mathit{x}</code> | Italic (default) | x |
| <code>\mathrm{x}</code> | Roman / upright | x |
| <code>\mathbb{R}</code> | Blackboard bold | $\mathbb{R}$ |
| <code>\mathcal{L}</code> | Calligraphic | $\mathcal{L}$ |
| <code>\mathsf{x}</code> | Sans-serif | x |
| <code>\mathtt{x}</code> | Monospace | $\mathtt{x}$ |
| <code>\boldsymbol{\alpha}</code> | Bold symbol | $\boldsymbol{\alpha}$ |
| <code>\text{words}</code> | Normal text in math | words |

| DELIMITERS & BRACKETS | | | |
|--|-------------------|---|-------------------|
| COMMAND | OUTPUT | COMMAND | OUTPUT |
| <code>\left(\right)</code> | $()$ | <code>\left[\right]</code> | $[]$ |
| <code>\left\{ \right\}</code> | $\{\}$ | <code>\left \right </code> | $ $ |
| <code>\left \right </code> | $ $ | <code>\left\langle \right\rangle</code> | $\langle \rangle$ |
| <code>\left\lfloor \right\rfloor</code> | $\lfloor \rfloor$ | <code>\left\lceil \right\rceil</code> | $\lceil \rceil$ |
| <code>\left. \right </code> | evaluated-at bar | <code>\Big(\Big)</code> | large $()$ |
| <code>\left / \right</code> auto-size to content height — always use them in pairs | | Manual sizes: <code>\big < \Big < \bigg < \Bigg</code> | |